Name: .....
ID: .....

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FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
EL117
Academic Writing
All Branches
MTA Exam

2025-2026 /Summer
Date: 4 August 2026
2:30 – 4:00

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 8 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** **1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

You are required to answer ALL the sections.

1. In section 1, apply the learned skills for writing focus by answering analytical questions related to unity, cohesion, structure, and mechanics of writing.
2. In section 2, choose only one topic and outline a four-paragraph essay.
3. In section 3, write a standard essay: start with an introduction, develop well-written body paragraphs, and end with a concluding paragraph. After you finish writing your essay, edit and proofread it, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
4. Cross out any notes you make that you do not want to consider.
5. Devote 5 minutes to reading through the whole paper and making the appropriate selection of questions.

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's Initials & Signature
Section I: Writing Focus & Editing	20	10		
Section II: Essay Outlining	15	5		
Section III: Essay Writing	55	15		
Total in Figures		30		

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Total in Letters		90 Minutes	Thirty Marks		
Section	1	Writing Focus & Editing	10 POINTS	20 MINUTES	

Choose the right answer from a, b, c, or d. *(1 point each)*

1. Which sentence best combines the pair of clauses to form a correct sentence?
"The scientist collected data carefully. The results were highly reliable."

a. The scientist collected data carefully, so the results were highly reliable.
b. The scientist collected data carefully, but the results were highly reliable.
c. The scientist collected data carefully; however, the results were highly reliable.
d. Although the scientist collected data carefully, the results were highly reliable.

2. Coordination conjunctions combine two clauses. What relation does the sentence below show?
"Sara wanted to attend the conference, but she could not get a visa."

a. Result
b. Addition
c. Contrast
d. Cause

3. Which sentence best combines the pair of clauses to form a correct sentence?
"The restaurant received excellent reviews. More customers visited it. The business expanded."

a. The restaurant received excellent reviews, so more customers visited it, and the business expanded.
b. Because the restaurant received excellent reviews, more customers visited it, and the business expanded.
c. The restaurant received excellent reviews; more customers visited it; the business expanded.
d. All of the above

4. Choose the revision that has correct subject-verb agreement in the following sentence.
"Each of the participants _____ a certificate after completing the training program."

a. receive
b. receives
c. receiving
d. have received

5. What do the underlined words in bold do?
*"**As a result,** the city experienced a significant decrease in air pollution."*

a. Show contrast
b. Give an example
c. Show a result
d. Show sequence

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6. Which of the following is the correct description of the following sentence?

"The students prepared their presentations, and they delivered them confidently."

a. Run-on sentence
b. Fragment sentence
c. Comma splice
d. Complete sentence

7. Which of the following sentences is a run-on sentence?

a. The company launched the campaign, and sales increased immediately.
b. The company launched the campaign; sales increased immediately.
c. The company launched the campaign sales increased immediately.
d. After launching the campaign, the company saw increased sales.

8. Read the following introductory paragraph and then select the most appropriate thesis statement.

Online learning has become increasingly popular in recent years. It provides flexibility and access to educational opportunities for students around the world. However, some learners face challenges such as limited interaction, technical difficulties, and the need for self-discipline. .....

a. Online learning is the only effective form of education.
b. Online learning offers flexibility and accessibility, but it also presents challenges that learners must overcome.
c. Traditional classrooms should be eliminated.
d. Technology has no role in education.

9. Read the following paragraph and then select the most appropriate topic sentence.

..... Healthy eating habits contribute to physical well-being and disease prevention. A balanced diet provides essential nutrients that support growth and energy. Consuming fruits, vegetables, and whole grains can reduce the risk of many health problems. In addition, proper nutrition supports mental health and overall quality of life.

a. Many people enjoy eating fast food.
b. Healthy eating is important for maintaining overall health and well-being.
c. Fruits are available in many colors and varieties.
d. Restaurants offer a wide range of meals.

10. Read the paragraph below, then choose the best concluding sentence.

Traveling allows people to experience new cultures, traditions, and ways of life. It broadens perspectives and encourages personal growth. Travelers often develop a greater appreciation for diversity and improve their communication skills. Additionally, travel creates memorable experiences that can last a lifetime. .....

a. Hotels offer different types of accommodation.
b. Airplanes are one of the fastest forms of transportation.
c. Some destinations are more expensive than others.
d. In conclusion, traveling enriches people's lives by promoting learning, personal development, and cultural understanding.

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Section	2	Outlining	5 POINTS	15 MINUTES

Outline ONE of the following topics using the graphic organizer below. *(5 points)*

1. Write **a narrative essay** about a person who has had a positive influence on your life. Describe the person's character, actions, and achievements. Explain how this individual inspired, supported, or guided you, and discuss the lasting impact they have had on your life.

2. Write **a cause-and-effect essay** examining the effect of technology on interpersonal communication. Analyze both positive and negative effects, such as increased connectivity, reduced face-to-face interaction, and changes in language use. Support your discussion with real-life examples and observations.

Introductory Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Hook/Opening statement:

_____

_____

Thesis statement:

_____

_____

Body Paragraph (1): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (1):

_____

_____

Major supporting details:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Body Paragraph (2): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (2):

_____

_____

Major supporting details:

_____

_____

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Concluding Paragraph: *(1.5 point)*

Restatement of the thesis:

Final comment:

Section	3	Essay Writing	15 POINTS	55 MINUTES

Write a four-paragraph essay (300-350 words) on the same topic that you have outlined in the previous section. **(15 points)**

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